Wisdom and the Temple

1 Kings 3–6 · Proverbs 9:10

The big idea: When God said, "Ask what I shall give you," Solomon asked for wisdom to serve God's people, and God gave it generously. Then Solomon built the temple on Mount Moriah. Biblical wisdom begins with the fear of the LORD, and Christ grows it in all who come to him.

Before you meet: Read

1 Kings 3:3–28 | 1 Kings 6:1–14 | James 1:5

Open (5 minutes)

If you could ask God for one thing and know he would give it, what would you ask for?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Give your servant therefore an understanding _____ to govern your people, that I may discern between good and evil." *(1 Kings 3:9)*

"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of _____." *(Proverbs 9:10)*

"In the four hundred and _____ year after the people of Israel came out of the land of Egypt… he began to build the house of the LORD." *(1 Kings 6:1)*

Discuss

1. Solomon asked for an understanding mind and not for wealth or long life. What does his request teach you about prayer? *1 Kings 3:5–14; James 1:5*

2. The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom. How is that different from simply being smart or successful? *Proverbs 9:10*

3. God told Solomon a beautiful building could never replace a faithful heart. Where are you tempted to let outward things stand in for faithfulness? *1 Kings 6:12–13*

Memory verse

> *"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and the knowledge of the Holy One is insight."*
>
> **Proverbs 9:10**

Pray

Ask God for wisdom for one decision in front of you. Thank him that he gives generously to all who ask without reproach.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 29

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Kings 3:5–14 and 6:11–14 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (1 Kings 8 and 11).

Main points to land

1. Solomon asked for wisdom to serve God's people, and God gave it generously, along with riches and honor (1 Kings 3:9–13).
2. Biblical wisdom begins with the fear of the LORD. It is skill for living that comes from knowing God (Proverbs 9:10).
3. Solomon began the temple in 966 BC on Mount Moriah, named for the land where God once provided a ram in Isaac's place (1 Kings 6:1; 2 Chr. 3:1).

Answer key (Observe)

1. mind
2. wisdom
3. eightieth

Questions people will ask

Does God promise to make me rich if I ask for wisdom, as he did Solomon?

No. God gave Solomon riches and honor as Israel's king, for a particular purpose (1 Kings 3:13). The promise for every believer is wisdom: "let him ask God… and it will be given him" (James 1:5). Christ himself is our treasure (Col. 2:3). Keep the group on what God promises to everyone.

Closing prayer

Father, you are the giver of wisdom. Like Solomon, we are in over our heads. Teach us to fear you, give us understanding minds, and make us more like Jesus, in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. Amen.